

DBS Group (DBSM.SI): DBS NDR Takeaways: Wealth, AI and growth opportunities in focus

We hosted DBS CEO Tan Su Shan on a UK NDR. Overall, the tone was constructive, with investor discussions centred on wealth management, technology and AI, and the bank's growth opportunities. We came away positive on DBS's growth trajectory, supported by its wealth momentum, a more favourable interest rate outlook and multiple growth opportunities across Taiwan, financial institutions, custody, payments and transaction banking. In addition, management remains committed to disciplined capital allocation and optimisation. Taken together, we believe DBS remains well positioned to sustain and potentially improve profitability over time, supporting its premium P/B valuation.

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1. Wealth remains the key growth engine

Wealth was the most discussed topic throughout the NDR. Management remains positive on wealth momentum, with net new money continuing to run at around S\$40bn annually and growth broad based across the franchise. Discussions focused heavily on recent Chinese cross border regulatory changes, where management remained constructive on the outlook for Chinese wealth flows. While the new regulations may result in additional documentation requirements and tighter onboarding checks, management does not expect a material impact on long term wealth growth. More broadly, DBS continues to view Asian wealth creation, diversification needs, estate planning and cross border wealth management as structural growth drivers.

In addition, DBS sees opportunities to further expand its onshore wealth presence in mainland China and continues to invest in branch expansion and relationship manager capacity. Beyond mainland China, management highlighted Taiwan as an attractive growth market, while Singapore and Hong Kong continue to deliver healthy wealth growth and inflows. Overall, management remains confident that wealth can continue to grow at a healthy pace and remain a key driver of profitability and returns for the group.

2. NII outlook has improved with higher rates

Interest rates were another area of discussion during the NDR. Management highlighted that DBS remains most sensitive to Singapore dollar rates, with every 1bp move in SGD rates contributing approximately S\$11m to NII, while every 1bp increase in US rates has an estimated negative impact of around S\$4m. While the size of the structural hedge remains broadly unchanged, the recent increase in SORA (Singapore overnight rate average) and the steeper yield curve have improved the

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earnings outlook relative to the start of the year. Management noted that previous assumptions incorporated a meaningful decline in reinvestment yields as hedges rolled off, but recent rate moves imply less drag from structural hedge reinvestment going forward. Combined with continued balance sheet growth, this provides potential upside to current NII expectations should the higher for longer rate environment persist.

3. Technology and AI are creating capacity for growth

Management emphasised that AI is being deployed across the organisation to enhance productivity, improve customer engagement and, more importantly, create capacity for future growth. DBS has already invested heavily in data infrastructure and will continue to do so, which management views as a key competitive advantage. Rather than focusing solely on workforce reductions, the strategy is to redeploy capacity towards higher value activities, deepen client engagement and improve service delivery. AI is increasingly being deployed across customer journeys, software development, operations and internal processes, helping the bank scale more efficiently while creating additional capacity that can be redeployed towards growth opportunities across the franchise.

4. Capital return remains a priority

Management reiterated its commitment to the capital return framework already announced. While approximately S\$2.6bn of the buyback programme remains outstanding, management stressed that excess capital will ultimately be returned to shareholders. Depending on market conditions, this could continue through buybacks or alternative mechanisms such as special dividends or others. Management remains comfortable operating within its 12.5% to 13.5% CET1 range and continues to focus on both organic growth opportunities and disciplined capital allocation.

5. Multiple growth opportunities remain available across the franchise

Beyond wealth, management highlighted several areas where DBS continues to see attractive growth opportunities. Taiwan remains one of the fastest growing markets, supported by the Citi Taiwan acquisition, a stronger deposit franchise and continued wealth growth. Institutional banking opportunities also continue to expand across financial institutions, transaction banking, custody services, payments and RMB clearing, where DBS continues to benefit from its regional network and leading franchise positions.

In addition, DBS is seeing increasing demand from data centres, infrastructure financing and technology ecosystems across the region. Management also highlighted digital assets, treasury services and financial institutions banking as areas with further growth potential, as clients increasingly look to diversify counterparties, strengthen liquidity management and expand cross border business activities.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - DBS Group

We are Buy-rated on DBS with a 12-month target price of S\$68.3 (based on two-stage DDM). Key downside risks: (-) Unexpected rate cuts; (-) Unexpected asset quality deterioration; (-) Slower than expected growth in fee income.

DBSM.SI	12m Price Target: S\$68.30	Price: S\$72.03	Downside: 5.2%			
Buy	GS Forecast					
	Market cap: S\$204.6bn / \$158.6bn	Net inc. (\$ mn)	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	3m ADTV: S\$318.4mn / \$248.5mn	EPS (\$\$)	11,033.0	10,987.9	11,944.5	12,724.8
	Singapore	EPS growth (%)	3.88	3.89	4.26	4.54
	Asia Financials	P/E (X)	(3.1)	0.1	9.6	6.5
	M&A Rank: 3	P/B (X)	12.4	18.5	16.9	15.9
		ROA (%)	2.0	2.9	2.9	2.7
		ROE (%)	1.3	1.2	1.2	1.2
		Price/PPOP (X)	16.3	15.9	17.2	17.8
		Dividend yield (%)	15.0	15.0	13.9	12.9
			6.4	4.6	4.9	4.4
			3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
	EPS (\$\$)	1.03	0.94	1.03	0.85	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 14 Jul 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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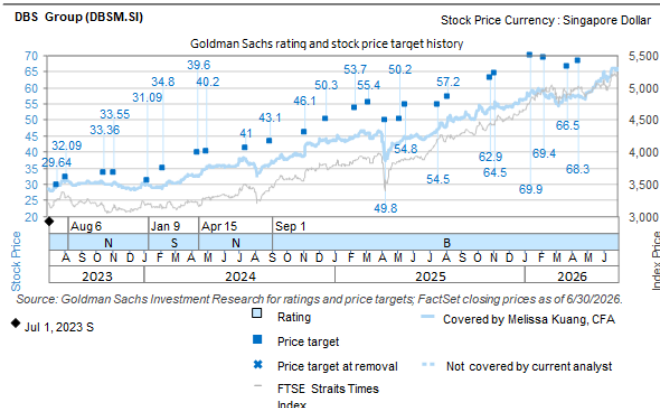
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DBS Group (DBSM.SI)

Date of report Target price (S\$) Closing price (S\$)

15-Apr-26	68.30	57.70
26-Mar-26	66.50	57.12
09-Feb-26	69.40	58.19
13-Jan-26	69.90	58.47
06-Nov-25	64.50	55.54
29-Oct-25	62.90	53.70
07-Aug-25	57.20	49.75
21-Jul-25	54.50	47.26
18-May-25	54.80	44.60
08-May-25	50.20	43.09
09-Apr-25	49.80	37.16
09-Mar-25	55.40	45.98
10-Feb-25	53.70	45.38
16-Dec-24	50.30	44.31
07-Nov-24	46.10	41.70
01-Sep-24	43.10	36.36
16-Jul-24	41.00	37.36
02-May-24	40.20	35.55
15-Apr-24	39.60	32.40
07-Feb-24	34.80	29.50
09-Jan-24	34.20	29.88
06-Nov-23	36.90	30.68
18-Oct-23	36.70	30.32
06-Aug-23	35.30	31.14
18-Jul-23	32.60	29.57

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